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AMEMBASSY NANKING

143 AUGUST 21, 3 PM

Following new developments may interest Wedemeyer mission. (Sent Embassy only 143 August 21):

1. Contrary earlier announcements postponing conscription on Taiwan Formosan youths now being summoned for physical examinations with induction slated for November. Formosans strenuously object Chinese military service, particularly on mainland and probably against Communists, and are also apprehensive at reported seizures Formosans as replacements for deserters from regular army on Taiwan estimated as high as 500 in Taipei area. Unconfirmed reports that part of 21st reorganized division being transferred from Taiwan to Manchuria cited as cause of high desertion rate. Compulsory military service for Formosans will exacerbate discontent with mainland administration.

2. Huang Chao-chin's attribution to General Wedemeyer that US has no "special interest" in Taiwan being interpreted locally with popular dismay and disappointment to mean US has no

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has no interest in Formosans. Huangs interview with Wedemeyer is strengthening rumor said to have been started by Huang himself that he will be appointed Governor of Taiwan. Such appointment would be disliked by majority of people despite Huang's technically being native Formosan.

3. Reliable information indicates both Governor and Madame Wei disconcerted at unfavorable impression they feel Wedemeyer mission received during visit and Governor has openly expressed doubt whether he will be considered competent to continue in his present post. Consulate also informed Wei so far unable to realize personal gain from his position owing inability obtain go-between whom he can trust. This tallies with earlier indications that hiseffectiveness minimized by lack of supporters in administration personally loyal to him.

4. There are continuing reports and some concrete evidence that Chen Li still exerting strong influence on island through military and civilian connections.

BLAKE

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8/22/47 10am

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